

In physics, **gravity** (from [Latin](#) *gravitas* 'weight'^[1]) is a [fundamental interaction](#) which causes mutual attraction between all things with [mass](#) or [energy](#). Gravity is, by far, the weakest of the four fundamental interactions, approximately 10^{38} times weaker than the [strong interaction](#), 10^{36} times weaker than the [electromagnetic force](#) and 10^{29} times weaker than the [weak interaction](#). As a result, it has no significant influence at the level of [subatomic particles](#).^[2] However, gravity is the most significant interaction between objects at the [macroscopic scale](#), and it determines the motion of [planets](#), [stars](#), [galaxies](#), and even [light](#).

On [Earth](#), gravity gives [weight](#) to [physical objects](#), and the [Moon's gravity](#) is responsible for sublunar [tides](#) in the oceans (the corresponding antipodal tide is caused by the inertia of the Earth and Moon orbiting one another). Gravity also has many important biological functions, helping to guide the growth of plants through the process of [gravitropism](#) and influencing the [circulation](#) of fluids in [multicellular organisms](#). Investigation into the effects of [weightlessness](#) has shown that gravity may play a role in [immune system](#) function and [cell differentiation](#) within the human body.

The gravitational attraction between the original gaseous matter in the [Universe](#) allowed it to [coalesce](#) and [form stars](#) which eventually condensed into galaxies, so gravity is responsible for many of the large-scale structures in the Universe. Gravity has an infinite range, although its effects become weaker as objects get farther away.